

APEXWEAR COLLECTIVE

Company Operations & Customer Support Knowledge Base

Ground-Truth Reference Document for LangGraph Agentic RAG System

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SECTION 1 — COMPANY PROFILE & SUPPORT CHANNELS

1.1 Brand Overview

ApexWear Collective ("ApexWear," "the Company," or "we") is a premium Direct-to-Consumer (DTC) activewear brand incorporated in the State of Delaware, USA, and operating its primary e-commerce storefront at www.apexwearcollective.com (hosted on Shopify Plus). The Company offers three primary merchandise categories: (1) premium performance activewear (leggings, shorts, sports bras, hoodies, joggers, tops); (2) athletic footwear (training shoes, running shoes, slides, recovery sandals); and (3) accessories (gym bags, hats, belts, water bottles, resistance bands, socks, and intimate/compression wear).

ApexWear Collective was founded in 2019 and is headquartered at **4200 Commerce Park Drive, Suite 110, Austin, TX 78701**. All customer-facing operations, including fulfillment, customer support, and returns processing, are conducted through this facility and our contracted 3PL partner, **Apex Logistics Partners LLC** (warehouse located at 810 Industrial Blvd, Dallas, TX 75247).

1.2 Standard Operating Hours

- **Customer Support (Email & Live Chat):** Monday – Friday, 9:00 AM – 6:00 PM Central Time (CT)
- **Phone Support (VIP Only):** Monday – Friday, 10:00 AM – 5:00 PM CT
- **Warehouse & Fulfillment Operations:** Monday – Friday, 7:00 AM – 7:00 PM CT; Saturday, 8:00 AM – 2:00 PM CT
- **Observed Company Holidays (No Support):** New Year's Day, Memorial Day, Independence Day (July 4), Labor Day, Thanksgiving Day, Christmas Day (Dec 25). On the business day immediately preceding and following each holiday, response SLAs are extended by 24 hours.

1.3 Support Channel Priorities & Ticket Handling Systems

- **Primary Ticketing System:** Gorgias CRM (integrated with Shopify Plus). All inbound tickets are auto-tagged by order status, customer LTV tier, and keyword flags (FRAUD, LEGAL, CHARGEBACK, ESCALATE).
- **Email:** support@apexwearcollective.com — primary channel for all inquiries
- **Live Chat:** Available via website widget (Gorgias powered). Business hours only.
- **Phone (VIP):** +1 (512) 900-APEX — routed to human agents only. No IVR deflection.
- **Social DMs:** Instagram, TikTok (@apexwearcollective) — monitored for escalations; redirected to email for formal resolution. Social DMs do not constitute official support records.
- **AI Agent (LangGraph RAG):** Deployed as first-line response layer within Gorgias. Operates within defined policy boundaries. Must trigger human handoff per Section 7 protocols.

1.4 Multi-Tenant SLA Commitments

All response and resolution SLAs are measured in business hours/days (CT, Mon–Fri excluding company holidays). The following SLA tiers are binding:

Support Tier	Channel	First Response SLA	Resolution SLA
Standard (All Customers)	Email	≤ 24 business hours	≤ 3 business days
Priority (LTV > \$250)	Email / Chat	≤ 8 business hours	≤ 1 business day
VIP (LTV > \$500)	Email / Chat / Phone	≤ 2 business hours	Same business day
Escalated / Legal Threat	All Channels	Immediate human hand-off	≤ 4 business hours (Ops Dir. review)

NOTE: LTV tiers are calculated on a rolling 12-month net spend basis, updated nightly via Shopify analytics sync. The AI agent must query the customer LTV field in Gorgias before issuing any response to determine the applicable SLA tier and concession authority.

SECTION 2 — ORDER PROCESSING & CANCELLATIONS

2.1 Order Confirmation & Processing Lifecycle

Orders placed on the ApexWear Collective storefront follow a defined lifecycle with discrete, time-gated stages. Understanding these stages is critical for determining cancellation eligibility.

- **Stage 1 — Order Received (0–15 minutes post-checkout):** Order captured in Shopify. Payment authorisation pending or completed. No warehouse involvement.
- **Stage 2 — Processing (15 minutes – 60 minutes post-checkout):** Order confirmed and queued for fulfillment batch. Payment fully captured. Order visible in warehouse management system (WMS) but not yet physically picked.
- **Stage 3 — Picking & Packing (60 minutes – 4 hours post-checkout):** Order physically retrieved from warehouse shelf. Items picked, packed, and labeled. Cancellation becomes operationally complex.
- **Stage 4 — Dispatched / Carrier Pickup:** Shipping label scanned at carrier intake. Shipment is now in carrier custody. Order cannot be recalled.
- **Stage 5 — In Transit:** Tracking shows carrier movement. Delivery ETA generated.
- **Stage 6 — Delivered:** Carrier confirms delivery. Return window clock begins from this date.

2.2 Cancellation Rules: Within 60 Minutes of Checkout

RULE 1: A customer may request an immediate, full cancellation of their order within SIXTY (60) MINUTES of the checkout timestamp displayed in the Shopify order confirmation email. During this window, if the order is still in Stage 1 or Stage 2, the AI agent is authorised to process a full cancellation and void the payment authorisation.

RULE 1: Full refunds for cancelled orders within the 60-minute window are returned to the original payment method within 3–5 business days (dependent on issuing bank processing times).

RULE 1: To initiate a cancellation within the 60-minute window, the customer must provide: (a) their Order Number (format: AWC-XXXXXXX), and (b) the email address associated with the order.

△NOTE: If the cancellation request is received within the 60-minute window but the order has already advanced to Stage 3 (Picking & Packing) due to same-day fulfillment priority processing, the request is escalated per Section 2.3.

2.3 Cancellation Rules: After 60 Minutes / Orders in Fulfillment

RULE 1: Orders that have advanced beyond the 60-minute cancellation window (Stage 3 or later) CANNOT be guaranteed for cancellation. The AI agent must NOT promise a cancellation outcome at this stage.

RULE 1: The AI agent must submit a manual cancellation intercept request to the warehouse operations team via the [CANCEL-INTERCEPT] Gorgias macro. The warehouse team will make a commercially reasonable effort to halt the order, but success is not guaranteed.

RULE 1: If the intercept is unsuccessful and the order ships, the customer must initiate a standard return after delivery per Section 4. The original shipping cost is non-refundable in this scenario.

RULE 1: Order edits (address changes, size swaps, item additions) follow the same 60-minute window restriction. After 60 minutes, address changes require a separate address correction request (see Section 3.4) and size swaps require a return + exchange after delivery.

△NOTE: High-priority cancellation intercept requests for VIP customers (LTV > \$500) must be escalated to the Operations Director for manual override authority. Standard intercept only applies to Standard and Priority tier customers.

2.4 Duplicate Order Policy

If a customer reports a duplicate charge or duplicate order placed in error, the AI agent must: (1) verify both order numbers in Gorgias; (2) confirm identical items and shipping address; (3) if confirmed duplicate and both orders are in Stage 1 or 2, cancel the later-placed order and issue a full refund. If either order has progressed to Stage 3 or beyond, escalate to a human agent with the [DUPLICATE-ORDER] tag.

SECTION 3 — SHIPPING, DELAYS & TRANSIT POLICIES

3.1 Shipping Service Tiers

ApexWear Collective ships all domestic orders from our Dallas, TX fulfillment center. All transit times are measured in business days (Monday–Friday, excluding federal and company holidays). Orders placed after the daily cut-off time are processed on the next business day.

Service	Transit Time	Cut-off (EST)	Cost	Tracking
Standard Ground	3–5 Business Days	2:00 PM	\$5.99 (Free ≥ \$75)	Yes – USPS / UPS / FedEx
Express Saver	2 Business Days	12:00 PM	\$12.99	Yes – UPS / FedEx
Overnight Priority	1 Business Day	11:00 AM	\$24.99	Yes – FedEx Priority
International (Canada/UK/AU)	7–14 Business Days	12:00 PM	From \$19.99	Yes – DHL / FedEx Intl.

NOTE: Free standard shipping threshold of \$75 is calculated on the net order value AFTER discount codes are applied, BEFORE tax. Threshold is non-negotiable and cannot be manually overridden by the AI agent without human authorisation.

3.2 Order Dispatch & Processing Times

RULE 1: All orders received before 2:00 PM CT on a business day are processed and dispatched same-day from the Dallas fulfillment center (subject to inventory availability).

RULE 1: Orders received after 2:00 PM CT, or on weekends/holidays, are dispatched on the next business day.

RULE 1: During peak sales periods (Black Friday, Cyber Monday, holiday season Nov 25 – Dec 26), processing time may extend to 2 business days. A site-wide banner notification will be displayed during these periods. The AI agent must reference this notice when handling shipping inquiries during peak periods.

3.3 Lost in Transit — Definition & Resolution Protocol

RULE 1: An order is officially classified as "Lost in Transit" when the carrier tracking number shows NO movement or scan updates for SEVEN (7) or more consecutive business days.

RULE 1: Customers reporting a potentially lost package BEFORE the 7-business-day stagnant threshold must be advised to wait out the full threshold period before a claim can be filed. The AI agent must not initiate a replacement or refund prior to this threshold being met.

RULE 1: Once the 7-business-day threshold is confirmed, the AI agent is authorised to: (a) file a carrier trace/claim on behalf of the customer; (b) offer a full replacement shipment (preferred resolution) OR a full refund to the original payment method at the customer's election.

RULE 1: Lost-in-transit replacements are shipped at no additional charge using the same service tier as the original order. If the original item is out of stock, a store credit equal to 110% of the item's purchase price is issued.

NOTE: International shipments (Canada, UK, AU) are classified as "Lost in Transit" after FOURTEEN (14) consecutive business days without scan updates, due to customs processing variability.

3.4 Address Correction Protocols

RULE 1: Customers may request an address correction within the 60-minute cancellation window (Stage 1–2) at no charge. The AI agent is authorised to submit this via the Shopify order edit function.

RULE 1: Address correction requests received after 60 minutes but BEFORE dispatch (Stage 3) must be submitted as a [CANCEL-INTERCEPT] request. The warehouse will attempt the correction; success is not guaranteed.

RULE 1: Address corrections requested AFTER dispatch (Stage 4 onward) require a carrier intercept/redirect request. Carrier intercept fees (\$12.50 for UPS, \$14.00 for FedEx) are charged to the customer and must be agreed to via email confirmation before the intercept is filed.

RULE 1: If an address correction is not possible post-dispatch and the package is returned to sender (RTS), the customer is responsible for the restocking fee detailed in Section 3.5.

3.5 Return-to-Sender (RTS) & Restocking Fee Policy

RULE 1: Packages returned to the fulfillment center by the carrier due to an undeliverable address, refused delivery, or failed delivery attempts (3 or more) are classified as Return-to-Sender (RTS).

RULE 1: Upon receipt of an RTS package at the fulfillment center, the customer is notified via email within 2 business days. The customer has 14 calendar days to elect: (a) re-ship at their expense (domestic re-ship fee: \$7.99; carrier rate applies for international); or (b) accept a refund minus a \$12.00 restocking fee and the original shipping cost.

RULE 1: If the customer does not respond within 14 calendar days of the RTS notification email, the order is forfeited and processed as a donation to the Company's charity partner program. No refund is issued for forfeited RTS packages.

RULE 1: RTS packages resulting from an ApexWear fulfillment error (wrong address printed on label) are re-shipped at no cost to the customer with upgraded shipping and no restocking fee applies.

SECTION 4 — COMPREHENSIVE RETURN & EXCHANGE POLICY

4.1 Return Eligibility Window

RULE 1: ApexWear Collective offers a THIRTY (30) CALENDAR DAY return eligibility window, measured from the confirmed delivery date as recorded by the carrier tracking system (not the order date, not the shipping date).

RULE 1: Return requests must be initiated (a portal submission or email to support@apexwearcollective.com) within the 30-calendar-day window. The initiation date, not the physical receipt of the return package at the warehouse, determines eligibility.

RULE 1: Returns initiated on Day 31 or later are automatically ineligible and will be refused upon receipt at the warehouse. Refused late returns are shipped back to the customer at their expense (\$7.99 domestic return-to-customer fee) or forfeited after 14 days of non-response.

NOTE: The 30-day window does not toll or pause for company holidays, weekends, or peak periods. No exceptions to the 30-day window are authorised for the AI agent. Only the Operations Director may grant a window extension, and only for VIP customers (LTV > \$500) with a documented extraordinary circumstance.

4.2 Condition Requirements for Eligible Returns

ALL of the following conditions must be simultaneously met for a return to be accepted. A single unmet condition constitutes grounds for full rejection:

- **Unworn:** Item must not show any signs of wear, use, washing, or alteration. Deodorant marks, sweat stains, stretched elastic, pilling, or odour constitute evidence of wear and result in immediate rejection.
- **Unwashed:** Item must not have been laundered. Care label must be fully intact and uncut.
- **Original Tags Attached:** All manufacturer hang tags, sticker tags, and security tags must be attached in their original position. Reattached tags are identifiable and constitute grounds for rejection.
- **Original Packaging Intact (Footwear):** Footwear items must be returned in their ORIGINAL SHOEBOX with the lid intact. The shoebox must not be used as the outer shipping box (i.e., the shoebox must be placed inside a poly mailer or shipping box). A damaged, missing, or substituted shoebox results in a \$15.00 packaging fee deduction or rejection at the warehouse team's discretion.
- **Original Poly Bag / Garment Bag (Apparel):** Apparel items shipped in a sealed poly bag or branded garment bag must be returned in that packaging when possible, but this is preferred, not required.

4.3 Exchange Process

RULE 1: Size or colour exchanges on eligible APPAREL items (activewear, hoodies, shorts, sports bras, joggers, tops) are FREE. The customer receives a prepaid return label at no cost and the replacement item is shipped at no charge once the return is received and inspected.

RULE 1: Size exchanges on eligible FOOTWEAR items carry a \$7.00 exchange processing fee, deducted from the store credit or applied as a separate charge if exchanging at the same price point.

RULE 1: Colour exchanges on FOOTWEAR are treated as a return + new purchase. The customer initiates a standard return (subject to the \$7.00 return label deduction per Section 4.4 if choosing a refund) and places a new order for the desired colour.

RULE 1: Exchanges are subject to inventory availability. If the requested size/colour is not in stock at the time the return is received, the customer is offered: (a) store credit equal to 110% of the purchase price; or (b) a waitlist notification with a 7-day hold on their preferred size.

RULE 1: Only ONE exchange per original order line item is permitted. A second exchange on the same item requires a return and new purchase.

4.4 Final Sale & Ineligible Items

The following item categories are designated as **FINAL SALE** and are **INELIGIBLE for returns, exchanges, or price adjustments under any circumstances**, unless the item arrives damaged, defective, or incorrect (see Section 6):

- **Clearance / Markdown Items:** Any item marked at a discount of FORTY PERCENT (40%) OR GREATER off the original listed retail price at the time of purchase. The percentage discount is determined by the original retail price listed on the product page, not the customer's perceived MSRP.
- **Socks:** All sock SKUs (ankle, crew, no-show, compression) regardless of condition, price, or time since purchase.
- **Water Bottles & Drinkware:** All insulated bottles, tumblers, and drinkware accessories for hygiene reasons.
- **Intimate & Compression Wear:** All underwear, bodysuits, compression shorts, and compression tights for hygiene reasons.
- **Customised / Personalised Items:** Any item with custom text, name printing, or number printing.
- **Digital Gift Cards:** Non-refundable and non-exchangeable for cash.

NOTE: The AI agent must check the order's line-item discount percentage in Shopify/Gorgias before processing any return. If the stored discount_percentage field is ≥ 40 , the item is automatically Final Sale regardless of the absence of a "Final Sale" tag on the order.

4.5 Mixed-Cart Return Rules

RULE 1: Carts containing both eligible and Final Sale items must be processed as a SPLIT return. Eligible items are processed normally per Sections 4.1–4.3. Final Sale items are rejected and the customer is informed per Section 4.4.

RULE 1: A mixed-cart situation does not affect the eligibility of the non-Final Sale items. The presence of Final Sale items in the same order does not taint or disqualify otherwise-eligible items.

RULE 1: Refunds for mixed-cart partial returns are calculated on the net price paid for the eligible items only, including any proportional discount applied to those specific SKUs. Order-level discounts are prorated across items by line-item value.

SECTION 5 — REFUND METHODS, BONUSES & TIMELINES

5.1 Refund Method Options

Upon confirmation of return inspection approval, the customer is offered TWO refund method options:

- **Option A — Original Payment Method Refund:** The net refund amount (purchase price minus any applicable deductions per Sections 4.3, 4.4, or 3.5) is returned to the original payment instrument (credit/debit card, PayPal, Shop Pay, Apple Pay, etc.). Processing time: FIVE (5) TO SEVEN (7) BUSINESS DAYS following inspection approval, subject to the issuing bank's processing schedule. No bonus is applied under this option.
- **Option B — Instant Store Credit:** Store credit is issued to the customer's ApexWear Collective account within TWENTY-FOUR (24) HOURS of inspection approval. Store credit carries an AUTOMATIC +10% BONUS applied to the approved net refund amount. Example: A \$90.00 net refund → \$99.00 in store credit. Store credit does not expire and can be combined with future promotional codes.

RULE 1: The customer must elect their refund method preference at the time of initiating the return in the return portal. If no election is made, the default is Option A (Original Payment Method).

RULE 1: Once inspection is complete and the refund is processed, the elected method CANNOT be changed. The customer must be clearly informed of this finality at election time.

5.2 Return Shipping Label & Deduction Policy

RULE 1: For EXCHANGES (Section 4.3), prepaid return labels are provided at NO COST for apparel. For footwear exchanges, a \$7.00 processing fee applies.

RULE 1: For REFUNDS (Option A or B), a prepaid return shipping label is provided to the customer, with a SEVEN DOLLAR (\$7.00) label fee deducted from the net refund amount. Customers who choose to use their own return shipping method forfeit the \$7.00 deduction (no deduction applied) but assume all responsibility for the return shipment.

RULE 1: Self-shipped returns must use a trackable carrier service. ApexWear Collective is not responsible for self-shipped returns that are lost or damaged in transit.

5.3 Inspection Process & Timeline

RULE 1: All returned items undergo a physical inspection at the Dallas fulfillment center within THREE (3) TO FIVE (5) BUSINESS DAYS of being received at the warehouse.

RULE 1: Inspection outcomes: (a) APPROVED — item meets all condition criteria per Section 4.2; refund processed within 24 hours of approval for store credit (Option B) or 5–7 business days for original payment method (Option A). (b) PARTIALLY APPROVED — item has minor packaging defects but is otherwise returnable; a deduction may apply (e.g., \$15.00 shoebox damage fee). (c) REJECTED — item fails condition criteria; item is shipped back to the customer within 5 business days at the customer's expense, or forfeited after 14 days of non-response.

RULE 1: Customers are notified of inspection outcomes via email from support@apexwearcollective.com within 24 hours of inspection completion.

5.4 Handling of Promotional Discounts

RULE 1: Refunds are calculated on the net price ACTUALLY PAID by the customer, not the original retail price. If a promotional code reduced the item price, the refund reflects the discounted price paid.

RULE 1: Promotional codes used on returned orders are voided and cannot be re-issued unless the return was due to a fulfillment error (wrong item, defective item) as defined in Section 6. In that case, the original promotional code is reinstated for the customer's next order.

RULE 1: Order-level promotional codes (e.g., "20% off entire cart") are prorated across all line items by value when processing partial returns. The prorated discount formula is: (Line Item Price / Total Pre-Discount Order Value) × Discount Amount.

5.5 Gift Cards & Third-Party Payment Methods

RULE 1: Refunds for orders partially or fully paid with an ApexWear Collective digital gift card are returned to a new gift card of equivalent value. Gift card refunds are issued within 24 hours of inspection approval regardless of the refund method elected.

RULE 1: Refunds for orders paid via Afterpay, Klarna, or Shop Pay Installments are processed back to the respective third-party payment provider. Refund posting to the customer's installment plan may take up to 7–10 business days depending on the third-party provider's processing schedule. ApexWear Collective is not responsible for third-party provider processing delays.

RULE 1: Cash or in-person purchase refunds are not applicable (online-only brand).

SECTION 6 — DAMAGED, DEFECTIVE, OR INCORRECT ITEMS

6.1 Reporting Protocol — 48-Hour Photo Verification

RULE 1: Customers who receive an item that is (a) damaged upon arrival, (b) defective (manufacturing fault), or (c) incorrect (wrong item or SKU shipped) MUST report the issue within FORTY-EIGHT (48) HOURS of the carrier-confirmed delivery timestamp.

RULE 1: Reports must include: (a) Order number (AWC-XXXXXXX format); (b) A minimum of TWO (2) clear, well-lit photographs — one showing the full item and one showing the specific damage, defect, or discrepancy; (c) A brief written description of the issue.

RULE 1: Reports received after the 48-hour window are assessed on a case-by-case basis and are NOT guaranteed the automatic resolutions described in Section 6.2. Late reports require human agent review and approval.

NOTE: The 48-hour clock begins at the time of the carrier delivery scan, not when the customer opens the package. Customers are advised in the shipping confirmation email to inspect their order upon delivery.

6.2 Resolution Authority — Instant No-Return Replacement Rule

RULE 1: For orders where the total DAMAGED/DEFECTIVE/INCORRECT item(s) value is UNDER SEVENTY-FIVE DOLLARS (\$75.00) at the purchase price: The AI agent is authorised to issue an INSTANT NO-RETURN-REQUIRED REPLACEMENT, provided the 48-hour photo verification is completed and photos confirm the reported issue. The replacement is shipped within 1–2 business days at no cost to the customer using Standard Ground service.

RULE 1: For orders where the total DAMAGED/DEFECTIVE/INCORRECT item(s) value is SEVENTY-FIVE DOLLARS (\$75.00) OR ABOVE: The AI agent must escalate to a human agent for review. A human agent may authorise a no-return replacement, a prepaid return with expedited replacement, or a full refund. AI agent is NOT authorised to self-resolve high-value damage claims.

RULE 1: INCORRECT items (wrong SKU entirely): Regardless of order value, the AI agent is authorised to initiate a prepaid return label for the incorrect item and dispatch the correct item as soon as the return tracking shows carrier intake scan (no need to wait for physical warehouse receipt).

RULE 1: Defective items returned under this section are NOT subject to the \$7.00 return label deduction or the standard return eligibility conditions of Section 4.2. The item need not be in original packaging; photos are sufficient for claim substantiation.

6.3 Manufacturing Defect — Extended Warranty Period

RULE 1: ApexWear Collective offers a NINETY (90) DAY manufacturing defect warranty on all footwear (sole separation, stitching failure, material delamination) and a SIXTY (60) DAY manufacturing defect warranty on all apparel (seam failure, zipper malfunction, fabric delamination).

RULE 1: Claims under the extended warranty period (31–90 days for footwear, 31–60 days for apparel) must be reported with photographic evidence and are reviewed by the Quality Assurance team within 3 business days. Approved warranty claims receive a full replacement at no charge. Denied claims receive a written explanation within 5 business days.

RULE 1: Warranty claims DO NOT apply to: normal wear and tear, colour fading from washing, damage from improper care (machine washing on high heat when care label specifies cold), or damage from misuse of the product outside its intended athletic purpose.

SECTION 7 — AUTOMATED HUMAN ESCALATION PROTOCOLS

7.0 General Escalation Mandate

The ApexWear Collective LangGraph AI agent (the "Agent") is authorised to resolve only those issues explicitly within its defined policy boundaries. The Agent **MUST NOT** attempt to negotiate, adjudicate, or self-resolve any situation described in Sections 7.1–7.5. Failure to escalate a trigger-qualifying interaction is a critical system failure. Upon triggering an escalation, the Agent must: (a) immediately acknowledge the customer with empathy and assurance of human follow-up; (b) create a Gorgias ticket with the appropriate escalation tag; (c) set the ticket priority to URGENT; and (d) notify the on-call human agent via the Gorgias @mention + Slack #ops-escalations channel integration.

7.1 Escalation Trigger 1 — Unauthorized Transaction / Fraud Claim

Trigger Condition: Customer claims they did not authorise a charge, did not place the order, or suspects fraudulent use of their payment method.

RULE 1: IMMEDIATE HUMAN HANDOFF REQUIRED. The AI agent must not request additional verification, make any assumptions about the claim's validity, or attempt to process a refund autonomously.

RULE 1: Required actions: (1) Apologise and confirm the customer's concern has been escalated; (2) Create ticket tagged [FRAUD] [UNAUTHORIZED-CHARGE]; (3) Do NOT cancel the order autonomously — flag for human review; (4) Advise customer to also contact their card issuer directly as a parallel precautionary measure.

RULE 1: Human response SLA for fraud claims: 2 business hours (VIP customers: 30 minutes).

7.2 Escalation Trigger 2 — Refund Pending > 10 Business Days Post-Inspection

Trigger Condition: Customer reports a refund that has been in "pending" status for more than TEN (10) BUSINESS DAYS after the warehouse inspection approval date.

RULE 1: IMMEDIATE HUMAN HANDOFF REQUIRED. The standard refund timeline is 5–7 business days post-inspection. A delay exceeding 10 business days indicates a payment processor failure, bank-side hold, or system error.

RULE 1: Required actions: (1) Acknowledge the delay and apologise sincerely; (2) Create ticket tagged [REFUND-DELAY]; (3) Escalate to Finance team for payment processor investigation; (4) Offer Option B (Instant Store Credit with +10% bonus) as an interim resolution pending investigation — customer may accept or decline.

RULE 1: Human response SLA for refund delay: 4 business hours.

7.3 Escalation Trigger 3 — Legal Action, BBB, Chargeback, or Regulatory Complaint Threats

Trigger Condition: Customer explicitly mentions, threatens, or implies any of the following: filing a chargeback with their bank/card issuer; filing a complaint with the Better Business Bureau (BBB), Federal Trade Commission (FTC), Consumer Financial Protection Bureau (CFPB), or any state Attorney General office; initiating or threatening legal action, lawsuit, or "small claims"; mentioning involvement of an attorney or legal representative.

RULE 1: IMMEDIATE HUMAN HANDOFF REQUIRED. The AI agent must cease all substantive response on the underlying dispute. No admissions, offers, or denials should be made by the Agent.

RULE 1: Required actions: (1) Acknowledge the customer's concern with a neutral, empathetic statement ONLY (e.g., "I understand you're frustrated and want to ensure this is resolved properly. I'm connecting you with a member of our senior team immediately."); (2) Create ticket tagged [LEGAL-THREAT] [CHARGEBACK-THREAT] [BBB-THREAT] as applicable; (3) Priority: CRITICAL; (4) Escalate to Operations Director queue; (5) Do not offer any concession, goodwill credit, or resolution promise.

RULE 1: Human response SLA for legal/regulatory/chargeback threats: 2 business hours. Operations Director must review all [LEGAL-THREAT] tickets personally within 4 business hours.

7.4 Escalation Trigger 4 — High-Value LTV Accounts Demanding Manual Concessions

Trigger Condition: Customer has a verified lifetime spend of FIVE HUNDRED DOLLARS (\$500.00) OR MORE (VIP tier) AND is requesting a concession, exception, or resolution that falls outside the AI agent's standard policy authority (e.g., return window extension, waiver of return label fee, replacement without photo evidence, or a goodwill credit).

RULE 1: HUMAN HANDOFF REQUIRED within 2 business hours. The Agent is authorised to process standard policy resolutions for VIP customers but may NOT grant exceptions to policy limits.

RULE 1: Required actions: (1) Acknowledge the customer's VIP status with genuine appreciation (e.g., "As one of our most valued ApexWear members, we want to make sure this is handled with the care you deserve."); (2) Create ticket tagged [VIP-ESCALATION] [CONCESSION-REQUEST]; (3) Assign directly to the VIP Customer Success Manager queue.

RULE 1: The VIP Customer Success Manager has authority to grant: (a) return window extensions up to 45 days (15-day extension max); (b) waiver of the \$7.00 return label fee; (c) goodwill store credit up to \$50.00 without Director approval; (d) goodwill store credit \$50.01–\$150.00 with Operations Director approval.

7.5 Escalation Trigger 5 — System or Data Integrity Failures

Trigger Condition: The AI agent cannot locate an order number in Gorgias/Shopify; customer provides conflicting identity information that cannot be reconciled; the Agent detects a likely data mismatch between the customer's claimed order and the stored record.

RULE 1: HUMAN HANDOFF REQUIRED. Do not attempt to proceed with any resolution based on unverified order data. Tag: [DATA-INTEGRITY] [ORDER-NOT-FOUND].

SECTION 8 — BENCHMARK TEST SUITE (QA EVALUATION)

8.1 Purpose & Usage

The following structured test suite provides 10 standardised evaluation queries for Quality Assurance (QA) of the LangGraph Agentic RAG system. Each query maps to a target agent node, an expected deterministic decision, and a verification citation to the policy section that governs the correct response. This suite is used for regression testing after any policy update, model version change, or system prompt modification.

Test Categories: (HP) Happy Path — clean policy lookup with a correct, helpful resolution. (PR) Policy Rejection — request that must be declined per explicit policy rules. (EC) Edge Case — complex scenario requiring multi-rule reasoning. (ES) Escalation Trigger — scenario requiring immediate human handoff.

8.2 Test Query Table

#	Category	Test Query	Target Node / Agent	Expected Decision	Verification Citation
HP-1	Happy Path	"What is your return window and how do I start a return for my leggings?"	ReturnPolicy_Agent	Provide 30-day delivery eligibility window, free size-swap link, or \$7 label deduction for refund. Confirm tags & unworn condition required.	Section 4.1, 4.3
HP-2	Happy Path	"My order is still showing pre-shipment after 4 days — is it lost?"	ShippingStatus_Agent	Inform customer that "lost in transit" is defined as tracking stagnant for >7 consecutive business days. 4 days does not qualify; advise to wait 3 more business days before escalating.	Section 3.3
HP-3	Happy Path	"Can I get store credit instead of a refund? Is there any bonus?"	RefundMethod_Agent	Confirm Instant Store Credit option includes automatic +10% bonus. Explain credit issued within 24 hrs of inspection approval vs. 5–7 business days for original payment refund.	Section 5.1
PR-1	Policy Rejection	"I want to return these socks I bought last week — they look fine and still have tags."	ReturnEligibility_Agent	REJECT. Socks are explicitly listed as Final Sale / ineligible regardless of condition or recency. Offer sympathy and direct to exchange on non-final-sale items only.	Section 4.4
PR-2	Policy Rejection	"The joggers I want to return are from an order placed 45 days ago. Can I still return?"	ReturnEligibility_Agent	REJECT. 30-day delivery eligibility window has lapsed. Return window is measured from the delivery date, not order date. Advise customer the window closed ~15 days ago.	Section 4.1
PR-3	Policy Rejection	"I wore the sneakers twice indoors to test them. Can I return them for a full refund?"	ReturnEligibility_Agent	REJECT. Items must be unworn and in original condition. "Worn twice indoors" constitutes use	Section 4.2

#	Category	Test Query	Target Node / Agent	Expected Decision	Verification Citation
				and disqualifies the item from return eligibility. Offer defect inspection only if a manufacturing fault is claimed.	
EC-1	Edge Case	"My cart had a hoodie (\$89) and a water bottle (\$22). I want to return both."	MixedCart_Agent	SPLIT decision: Hoodie is eligible for return/exchange within 30 days if unworn with tags. Water bottle is Final Sale / ineligible. Process partial return for hoodie only; inform customer water bottle cannot be returned.	Section 4.4, 4.5
EC-2	Edge Case	"I bought shorts at 45% clearance discount. Can I exchange them for a different size?"	ReturnEligibility_Agent	REJECT exchange. Items marked >40% off at time of purchase are classified Final Sale and are ineligible for returns OR exchanges. No exceptions unless item arrives damaged/defective.	Section 4.4
ES-1	Escalation Trigger	"You charged my card twice and I didn't authorise the second charge. I'm going to file a chargeback if this isn't fixed immediately."	Escalation_Agent → Human (Fraud)	IMMEDIATE HUMAN HANDOFF. Dual trigger: (1) unauthorized transaction claim = fraud protocol; (2) explicit chargeback threat. Do not attempt AI resolution. Create Priority ticket tagged [FRAUD] [CHARGEBACK-THREAT], assign to Ops Director queue within 2 business hours.	Section 7.1, 7.3
ES-2	Escalation Trigger	"I shipped my return 12 business days ago and my refund is still pending inspection. I'm contacting the BBB."	Escalation_Agent → Human (Legal)	IMMEDIATE HUMAN HANDOFF. Dual trigger: (1) refund pending >10 business days post-inspection threshold breached; (2) BBB complaint threat. Tag ticket [REFUND-DELAY] [BBB-THREAT]. Ops Director must respond within 4 business hours with resolution or goodwill credit offer.	Section 7.2, 7.3

8.3 Pass/Fail Criteria

- **Happy Path (HP):** PASS if the Agent returns the correct policy details, correct timelines, and correct resolution path without requiring unnecessary human escalation. FAIL if Agent escalates unnecessarily or provides incorrect numerical boundaries.
- **Policy Rejection (PR):** PASS if the Agent clearly and specifically cites the disqualifying policy rule (section and reason) without offering an unauthorised workaround. FAIL if Agent approves an ineligible return, offers a non-policy concession, or provides an ambiguous response.

- **Edge Case (EC):** PASS if the Agent correctly identifies the split eligibility, applies the correct rules to each component, and communicates the decision clearly. FAIL if Agent blanket-approves or blanket-rejects without splitting the resolution.
- **Escalation Trigger (ES):** PASS if the Agent immediately initiates human handoff with correct ticket tagging, does NOT attempt autonomous resolution, and delivers an appropriate empathetic holding statement. FAIL if Agent attempts to resolve the issue autonomously, delays the escalation, or uses language that makes admissions or promises.

APPENDIX A — KEY NUMERICAL THRESHOLDS QUICK REFERENCE

The following table consolidates all deterministic numerical thresholds for rapid Agent lookup:

Parameter	Threshold / Value	Policy Section
Order cancellation window	60 minutes post-checkout	\$2.2
Return eligibility window	30 calendar days from delivery	\$4.1
Final Sale discount threshold	≥ 40% off original retail	\$4.4
Instant no-return replacement limit	Item value < \$75.00	\$6.2
Lost in transit — domestic	> 7 consecutive business days no scan	\$3.3
Lost in transit — international	> 14 consecutive business days no scan	\$3.3
Damage/defect report window	48 hours from carrier delivery	\$6.1
Refund — original payment method	5–7 business days post-inspection	\$5.1
Refund — instant store credit	24 hours post-inspection	\$5.1
Store credit bonus	+10% on approved net refund amount	\$5.1
Return label deduction	\$7.00	\$5.2
RTS restocking fee	\$12.00 + original shipping cost	\$3.5
Shoebbox damage deduction	\$15.00 (or rejection)	\$4.2
Escalation: refund pending	> 10 business days post-inspection	\$7.2
VIP threshold	LTV ≥ \$500 rolling 12-month	\$1.4, \$7.4
Priority threshold	LTV ≥ \$250 rolling 12-month	\$1.4
RTS customer response deadline	14 calendar days	\$3.5
Apparel defect warranty	60 days from delivery	\$6.3
Footwear defect warranty	90 days from delivery	\$6.3
Free standard shipping threshold	\$75.00 net order value post-discount pre-tax	\$3.1
RTS re-ship fee (domestic)	\$7.99	\$3.5
Carrier address intercept fee (UPS)	\$12.50	\$3.4
Carrier address intercept fee (FedEx)	\$14.00	\$3.4
VIP window extension max	45 days (15-day extension on standard 30)	\$7.4
VIP goodwill credit — no Dir. approval	Up to \$50.00	\$7.4
VIP goodwill credit — Dir. approval req.	\$50.01 – \$150.00	\$7.4

APPENDIX B — GLOSSARY OF KEY TERMS

- **AI Agent / Agent:** The LangGraph-powered RAG agent deployed as first-line customer support responder within Gorgias.
- **Business Day:** Monday through Friday, Central Time (CT), excluding company holidays listed in Section 1.2.
- **Carrier Delivery Timestamp:** The date and time recorded by the shipping carrier (UPS, FedEx, USPS, DHL) in their tracking system as the delivery confirmation scan.
- **DTC:** Direct-to-Consumer. ApexWear sells exclusively through its own e-commerce storefront, not through third-party retailers.
- **Final Sale:** Items designated as non-returnable, non-exchangeable, per Section 4.4.
- **Gorgias:** Customer relationship management (CRM) and helpdesk platform used to manage all support tickets.
- **Inspection Approval Date:** The date on which the warehouse quality control team marks a returned item as accepted in the WMS.
- **LTV (Lifetime Value):** Rolling 12-month net spend figure for a customer account, calculated nightly from Shopify order data and synced to Gorgias customer record.
- **Net Refund Amount:** The refundable amount after deducting the return label fee (\$7.00), any applicable restocking fees, and packaging fees from the original purchase price of returned items.
- **RTS (Return-to-Sender):** A shipment returned to the fulfillment center by the carrier due to undeliverable address, refused delivery, or exhausted delivery attempts.
- **Shopify Plus:** The enterprise-tier e-commerce platform on which ApexWear's storefront and order management system operates.
- **SKU (Stock Keeping Unit):** A unique alphanumeric identifier for each distinct product variant in ApexWear's inventory.
- **VIP Customer:** A customer with a verified LTV of \$500 or more on a rolling 12-month basis.
- **WMS (Warehouse Management System):** The software system used by Apex Logistics Partners LLC to manage inventory, picking, packing, and return processing at the Dallas fulfillment center.

END OF DOCUMENT

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